

■ By Kaveree Bamzai

Walk into Ram Gopal Varma's swanky new office as he's about to release *Sarkar Raj*. He should be sitting in the final mix, biting his nails, agonising over promos to be issued? Er no. He's holding forth on his current interest. The cutting up of Neeraj Grover, who he's just found out used to work in the same building, into 300 pieces by his one-time girlfriend. Truly, when real life is so riveting, with a new B-movie every half-hour, how can cin-

ema compete? Well, it can by becoming as realistic and gritty. Take a look at some of the films that have done well this year. *Jannat*, a tuning in into the mind of the 21st century male, who believes in buy, consume and junk; *Aamir*, a relentless walk through the innards of his faith for a London-returned Muslim doctor; and *Sarkar Raj*, where the fictional Thakurwadi may well have stood in for Nandigram, as the Shepherd Power Plant could well be substituted for Enron Corporation.

And that's just the beginning. Coming up through the year, sprinkled

MISSION ISTAANBUL

Terrorists make their presence felt in a car-and-chopper actioner involving a journalist and a Turkish commando. **THE INSPIRATION:** Global terror attacks.



GRIME TIME

